

CHOMPER STUDIOS



La La Latte

Coffee Guru

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Design History

It is a simulation of making a cafe with opening hours from 08:00 to 16:00, where you are trained to make coffee.

Version 01

This version includes some tuning and tweaks after our initial design pass. It marks the shift from the original Tim Hortons queue simulation to the early concept of La La Latte: Coffee Guru.

- We reused assets from the Tim Hortons project and started prototyping coffee-making mechanics.
- Early design focused on drink preparation steps, with limited interaction and user feedback.
- Basic UI placeholders were added for customer orders and ingredient selection.
- We began planning a move from a passive simulation to an interactive training experience.
- The design scope was simplified to focus more clearly on core gameplay.
- Many areas, especially drink steps, scoring, and UI flow, were described in more detail.
- Story elements were added to show the player's journey from trainee to expert barista.
- The layout shifted to interactive drink stations instead of queue-based flow.
- Camera and time systems were still in development and not yet included.
- We also created a basic "pick-up order" system to serve customer needs.
- A stable prototype was completed for internal testing.

Version 02

This version includes refined turns and a final level, making the game more complete and challenging.

- We moved the coffee-making levels into a tutorial to help players learn the basics.
- The final level was refined to let players apply the skills they learned during the tutorial.
- The pick-up order system is still in place, and we've now added a reward system to motivate players and enhance engagement.

Game Overview

Philosophy

The purpose of this simulation is to train users in the art of preparing a wide variety of café beverages, simulating a realistic coffee shop environment using the assets and structure of a Tim Hortons-style cafeteria. The simulation aims to improve users' knowledge of drink recipes, preparation order, and time management under customer pressure.

By using interactive and engaging mechanics in a stylized café, this project provides a hands-on learning experience for aspiring baristas or staff trainees. It serves as both an educational tool and a gamified training platform, replicating real-world beverage service with intuitive gameplay.

Common Questions

What is the game?

The game is a barista training simulation set in a coffee shop where players learn and practice how to make various drinks (hot and cold) accurately and efficiently using virtual tools and ingredients.

Why create this game?

The project is designed to teach proper drink-making techniques, reinforce order accuracy, and develop speed and efficiency in a safe, controlled environment, ideal for training new employees or coffee enthusiasts.

Where does the game take place?

The simulation takes place in a stylized café modeled after Tim Hortons, utilizing the same asset base from the original queue simulation but now repurposed into a drink prep and service environment.

What do I control?

The player takes on the role of a barista and directly interacts with ingredients, tools, and customer orders through a first-person or top-down interface.

How many characters do I control?

Only one — the barista (the player). However, the player must manage and serve multiple customer orders.

What is the main focus?

The main focus is learning how to make café drinks correctly and efficiently, meeting customer expectations.

What's different?

This game focuses on active task execution, not just observation. It transforms passive data analysis into interactive skill development, blending education and engagement with realistic drink-making workflows.

Feature Set

General Features

- Real-time simulation of coffee drink preparation.
- Hands-on drink-making mechanics with real ingredient steps.
- Custom drink recipes ranging from simple to advanced beverages.
- Training and Challenge modes for progressive learning.
- Visual and audio feedback.

Training Mode

- Training Mode: Step-by-step guidance for each drink.

Progression System

- Unlock more complex drinks as you master easier ones.

The Game World

Overview

The game world is a stylized café environment designed to train players in drink-making. It includes various prep stations, ingredient areas, and a pickup counter.

Store Layout

- Drink Stations: Espresso machine, blender, tea infuser, syrup area.
- Ingredient Shelves: Milk, water, espresso shots and toppings.
- Pickup Counter: Where drinks are delivered to customers.
- Order Screen: Displays active customer orders.

Travel & Movement

- Players interact via fixed camera or point-and-click no character walking needed.
- Drink-making is focused on tool and object interaction at stations.

Objects in the World

- Drink-making tools (pitchers, cups, machines, blenders).
- Ingredient containers (syrups, coffee, milk).

- UI Order Tickets.
- Customers as animated 3D avatars.

Time Mechanics

- Simulation runs in real-time per session.
- Customer patience bars dynamically decrease based on wait time.

Rendering System

Overview

The simulation uses a Unity-based 2D/3D hybrid rendering style. Visual clarity is prioritized to ensure all drink-making tools and ingredients are easy to identify and interact with. Camera remains mostly fixed with possible zoom/pan support.

- Unity-based rendering system.
- 2D/3D hybrid visuals for clarity of tools, stations, and ingredients.
- Top-down/isometric view for full café visibility.

Camera

- Default View: Fixed isometric or top-down view.
- Zoom & Pan: Future feature to inspect stations up-close.
- Mouse controls for UI interaction and object selection.

Game Engine

Overview

The simulation is developed in Unity with C#. It handles real-time drink prep validation, ingredient tracking, timing calculations, and scoring logic.

- Developed in Unity with C#.
- Handles real-time recipe validation and scoring.
- Tracks timing, ingredient order, and accuracy.

Collision Detection

- Players interact via UI/clicks – no complex character movement needed.
- Only basic interaction detection for selecting tools or dragging ingredients.

Lighting Models

Lighting Model Detail #1

We are using a flat lighting style for simplicity and ease of visual identification.

Lighting Model Detail #2

No advanced lighting effects are required as the focus is instructional, not visual fidelity.

The World Layout

Overview

The layout consists of modular stations in a stylized café environment, each designed for a specific type of beverage preparation.

World Layout Detail #1

The café layout includes realistic barista stations and ingredients arranged in logical sequences to guide players through the correct drink-making flow.

World Layout Detail #2

Future expansions may include multiple café configurations, seasonal drink stations, and cold bar areas.

Game Characters

Overview

The characters provide a welcoming and relatable café experience, with varied appearances to simulate real customers.

- Customers appear with drink orders and animations.
- No customization – customers behave based on order logic.

User Interface

Overview

The user interface supports drink creation, order tracking, recipe references, and feedback collection — all in real time.

User Interface Detail #1

Displays active orders, timers, ingredients used, and current station status.

User Interface Detail #2

Interactive recipe guide, pause/restart buttons.

Musical Scores and Sound Effects

Overview

Sound plays an essential role in enhancing the realism and immersion of the Tim Hortons queue simulation. Various audio effects have been incorporated to create an authentic coffee shop environment.

Red Book Audio

We are not using Red Book Audio for this simulation. Instead, we rely on high-quality pre-recorded ambient sounds and effects to enhance the simulation's realism.

3D Sound

The simulation utilizes spatial audio processing in Unity to provide a dynamic and immersive sound environment. Sound effects are placed in a 3D space, ensuring realistic audio perception based on the player's camera position.

Sound Design

To recreate the atmosphere of a busy Tim Hortons location, we have integrated the following audio effects:

1. voices-in-cafe-68787 – Background chatter that simulates a lively coffee shop environment.
2. door-open-close-45475 – A subtle door opening and closing sound when customers enter or leave the shop.

3. door-slam-172171 – A heavier door slam effect for dramatic impact in specific moments.
4. jazz-cafe-164940 – A smooth jazz background music track to enhance the cozy café ambiance.

These sounds are played in loops or triggered dynamically based on in-game events such as customer arrivals, departures, and queue movements. Future enhancements could include more varied audio cues, such as machine noises for coffee preparation or specific customer reactions.

Single-Player Game

Overview

The single-player experience offers structured learning and challenges, with gradual complexity and replayability.

Single Player Game Detail #1

Includes both guided tutorial and fast-paced challenge sessions.

Single Player Game Detail #2

Player performance is tracked and scored per session, with feedback on improvement areas.

Story

The simulation does not follow a linear narrative but is structured around the player's growth as a "Coffee Guru," progressing from trainee to expert barista.

Hours of Gameplay

Each session is short and modular (3–5 minutes), with replayability across difficulty levels and drink types for extended engagement.

Victory Conditions

The traditional win/loss stats. Success is based on:

- Accuracy of drink preparation.
- Meet the customer's requirements.
- Meet a certain level of earning to level up.

Character Rendering

Overview

Customers and café elements are rendered using simplified 3D assets for clarity and smooth performance.

Character Rendering Detail #1

Simple animations for customers entering.

World Editing

Overview

A built-in editor may allow for training customization or layout testing in future iterations.

World Editing Detail #1

Future tools could let trainers adjust station positions, add new drink machines, or test complex service scenarios.

World Editing Detail #2

Potential for importing real-world café layouts for business-specific training simulations.

Extra Miscellaneous Stuff

Overview

Ideas for future expansion or creative features we may pursue down the line.

Crazy idea #1

Gamified certification system – players earn badges as they pass skill tests (e.g., “Latte Art Master,” “Cold Brew Pro”). This is already added in this game version.

Crazy idea #2

Augmented Reality (AR) drink-prep companion app for real-world practice using a mobile phone.

Objects Appendix

Additional imported assets from the Unity Asset Store:

1. BGM: Background music used in the simulation.
2. Clock: UI element showing real-time updates.
3. Free Food - Breakfast Time: Asset used for food representation.
4. Simple Cafe: Environmental assets representing the café.
5. Tavern Interior by I.We.D: Used for structural and decorative elements.
6. Toony Tiny People: Character models representing customers and employees.
7. Espresso Lightsign: Decorations.
8. Waste Bin Poly: The bin for resetting ingredients added list.
9. Fries and Seagull: The counter and interiors of the cafe in the final game level.

Tutorial: Lobby



- Left: Blackboard - an enter point to Iced Long Black tutorial
- Middle: Waitress, a counter, table & chair set, and a clock are decorations.
- Right: Standing Blackboard - an enter point to Caffe Latte tutorial

Tutorial: Iced Long Black



- Left: Notice Board - The recipe (instruction) of the drink.
- Middle: A glass for coffee made, and all ingredients needed for making the drink.
- Right: Memo is a decoration.

Tutorial: Caffe Latte



- Left: Notice Board - The recipe (instruction) of the drink.
- Middle: A cup for coffee made, and all ingredients needed for making the drink.
- Right: Memo is a decoration.

Game Level



- Customers: They are NPCs showing orders received.
- Waitress: A NPC.
- Clock: The time count in the game.
- Blackboard on the wall: The prices for each drink.
- Rubbish Bin: Reset ingredients added list button.
- Monitor: A display for earnings.
- Glass on the right on the tables: All ingredients needed to make a drink.
- A cup of coffee and A glass of coffee: The number of coffee made for each drink.
- Big Coffee, Clock, Counter, Tables: They are all decorations.

User Interface Appendix

Detailed breakdown of the UI elements and their functionality.

Game Start

Display a starting point for the game.



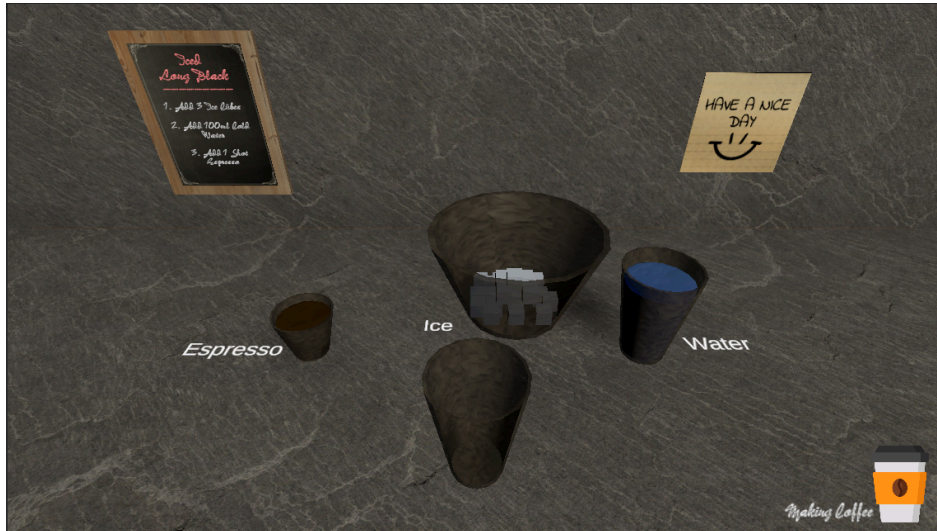
Tutorial: Lobby

Display the enter points to the tutorial levels. A button going to the final game level when all tutorials are finished.



Tutorial: Iced Long Black

The first level of tutorial. Displaying ingredients, and a button to refresh or go back to the lobby.



Tutorial: Caffe Latte

The second level of tutorial. Displaying ingredients, and a button to refresh or go back to the lobby.



Game Level

The final game level involves making orders and picking up the order system. Showing the ingredients name, ingredients added sequence, coffee made, earnings added, and time count.



Game Over

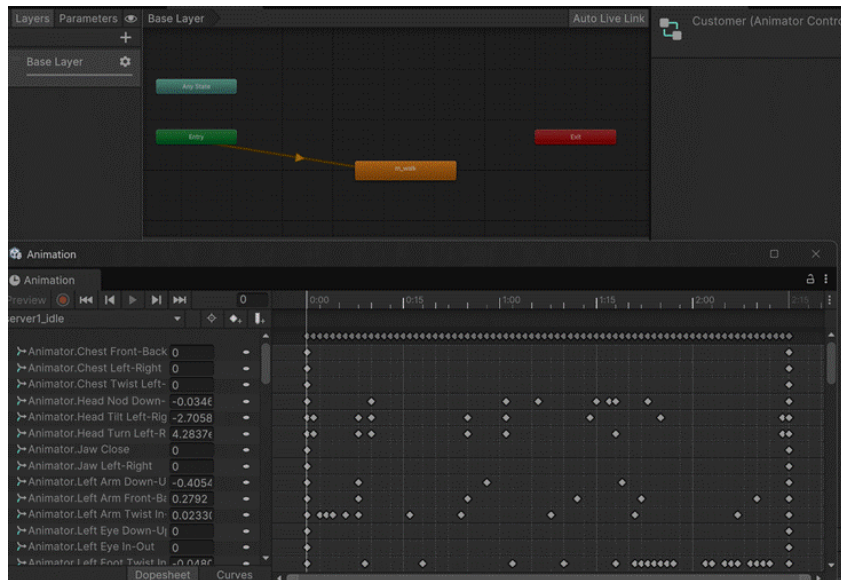
Displays end of shift, total earning and level achieved. A button to restart the game.



Character Rendering and Animation Appendix

Further details on customer visual representation and animation techniques.

Customer Animation diagrams



Conclusion

La La Latte: Coffee Guru is a hands-on, immersive simulation designed to train users in professional café drink preparation. By building on the asset base of our previous Tim Hortons queue simulation, this project shifts focus from operational efficiency to skill development and accuracy in a fast-paced service environment.

The game provides an engaging and educational platform for aspiring baristas or new staff members, offering real-time feedback, intuitive interfaces, and a realistic café atmosphere. With room for future expansion — including co-op gameplay, advanced customization, and gamified certifications — La La Latte is not just a simulation, but a foundation for practical, scalable barista training.

As development continues, the goal is to refine the user experience, expand recipe complexity, and increase the game's value as a training and onboarding tool across café environments.